

3.2 Programming

Students need a **theoretical understanding** of all the topics in this section for the paper 1 exam even if the programming language(s) taught does not support all of the topics. Exams will always present algorithms using the current version of the AQA pseudo-code. The document can be found on the AQA website.

Students need a **practical understanding** of all the topics and skills in this section for the paper 1 exam. When they are writing computer programs in an exam they will need to ensure they use meaningful identifier names, use suitable data types and that all logic flow is clearly identifiable to examiners.

Exam questions will explicitly state in what form the response needs to be provided. This will be, for example, pseudo-code, program code or a flowchart, and students must respond as instructed. Where pseudo-code is an accepted method of response, students may present their answers to questions in any suitable format and do not need to use the AQA pseudo-code.